THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 10 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 5: **Print Culture and the Modern World (History)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A woman published her autobiography in Bengali in 1876. She was 1

(a) Pandita Ramabai **(b)** Ram Chaddha **(c)** Rashsundari Debi **(d)** Tarabai Shinde

2. The printing of vernacular newspapers in India grew after 1857 partly because 1

(a) the British paid for them
(b) there were no censors
(c) colonial rule increased the reading public and political debate
(d) books were free

3. Which group benefited most from circulating libraries? 1

(a) only kings **(b)** only soldiers
(c) middle-class readers, including women **(d)** only monks

4. 'Reading mania' in eighteenth-century Europe means 1

(a) the decline of books **(b)** scarcity of books
(c) a Church ban on reading **(d)** a great eagerness among people to read

5. Assertion (A): Women's writing grew in the nineteenth century. Reason (R): More women became readers, and some wrote journals and autobiographies. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

6. Assertion (A): Print gave voice to critics of caste. Reason (R): Jyotiba Phule published Gulamgiri. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

7. Nationalist leaders were attracted to vernacular print because it 1

(a) reached ordinary people in their own languages
(b) avoided debate
(c) reached only the English-educated
(d) avoided Indians

8. Printing in Europe spread rapidly after 1450 because 1

(a) presses were set up in most European countries within a century
(b) the Church banned it
(c) readers were few
(d) paper was not available

9. **Assertion (A):** Menocchio, a miller in Italy, was punished by the Roman Church for his ideas. 1
Reason (R): The Roman Catholic Church welcomed all independent interpretations of the Bible.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** The Vernacular Press Act of 1878 was passed to encourage newspapers in Indian languages. 1
Reason (R): The Act gave the government extensive rights to censor reports and editorials in vernacular newspapers.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did colonial censorship backfire? 2

12. How did print shape ideas of childhood? 2

13. Why did conservatives fear women's reading? 2

14. How did print link local and global debates? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain how women read, wrote and faced resistance. 3

16. Explain how printing fostered national consciousness. 3

17. Explain the shift from manuscript to print. 3

OR

Examine the limits of print's reach in India. 3

18. Examine how images shaped political culture. 3

OR

Explain how print made scientific debates public. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Rashsundari Debi, a young married girl in a very orthodox household, learned to read in the secrecy of her kitchen. Later she wrote her autobiography Amar Jiban, published in 1876. It was the first full-length autobiography published in the Bengali language. Many conservative families feared that reading would corrupt women and make them disobedient. 5
(i) Who wrote Amar Jiban?
(ii) In which language was it written?
(iii) Where did she learn to read?
(iv) Why did conservative families oppose women's reading, and how did women still benefit from print?

20. Discuss the relationship between print and censorship in colonial India. 5

OR

Analyse how print gave voice to marginal groups. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks